

It was as early as 1995 that we started dubbing said year as 'The Year'; starting with Slackware which was released in '92 and gained popularity. Debian, expected to fail at first, was also among the list of honourable mentions. Especially among the early releases.

More recent ones include 2004, with the release of Ubuntu. 2005, with the release of SLED (technically making it the year of Linux for businesses).



Note to self: Don't forget the cute mascot

2007, when Dell started releasing machines with Ubuntu as the default OS. 2008 was actually a missed chance for Linux. Netbooks were coming into fashion and Microsoft had just released a travesty of a product, popularly known as Vista. But the distros that came bundled with the machines left a lot to be desired and Windows 7 hit the streets in beta the next year.

Before we delve in to the specifics of why that year is yet to come, let's take a moment to explain to the some important basics to the uninitiated.

Why Linux is so awesome

1. It's ready from the start

This might come as a surprise to many, but Linux (depending on the version you're using of course) can actually be a better package than Windows for out-of-the-box performance. While Windows itself does come with some basic apps pre-installed, distros like Ubuntu come with a whole bundle of free and powerful productivity apps that are bundled as part of the OS. You get things like a full-fledged office suite (OpenOffice or LibreOffice), a powerful photo editor (like Gimp) and an assortment of other apps. Windows will give you notepad and Wordpad, Paint and Internet Explorer.

It's not that there aren't basic versions of Linux or that you can't install an app of your choice on Windows, but for a novice, a distro like Ubuntu does seem to offer much more.

2. It drives itself

As long-term Windows users, you must have encountered situations where you're left scrounging around for drivers and cursing the fact that you don't